KIMBERLY (KIM) BELL

SENIOR SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER IN TEST (SDET)

Test Architecture | CICD | Accessibility
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Automation-first SDET/QA Engineer with ownership of test architecture and CI/CD release confidence. 8+ years across frontend engineering and quality leadership; progressed from React development to leading a shared Cypress/Typescript automation framework used by 10 engineering teams across 35 repositories. Built repeatable regression/release capability by integrating E2E suites into GitLab CI/CD, reducing hardening time from hours to minutes. Served as escalation point for flaky/ambiguous failures and separated product defects from automation/environment/network issues. Recent work includes Playwright testing and AI-assisted QA tooling.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Reason Consulting Corporation Remote, Contract, Part-time **Oct 2026 - current**

Accessibility QA Consultant

- Perform manual screen reader testing (VoiceOver) to validate website and application accessibility against WCAG 2.1/2.2 criteria in response to an ADA audit
- Document accessibility defects with clear reproduction steps and recommended fixes for developers
- Evaluate the team's automated accessibility testing, identifying gaps where automation misses real-world assistive technology issues and recommending improvements

Career Sabbatical - Medical leave; Available for full-time roles. **Jan 2024 - Nov 2025**

Ally Financial, Charlotte, NC **Dec 2018 - Dec 2023**

Senior SDET (Remote) **Jan 2022 - Dec 2023**

Promoted from feature engineer after becoming Ally's Cypress subject-matter expert during the Ember-to-React migration. Owned the shared web-automation platform and responsible for tackling any blockers to ensure the 2-week release cycles consistently met.

- Led transition from 100% manual to 90% automated testing across 10 teams in 2 years using Cypress, Testing Library, TypeScript, and Gitlab CI/CD, reducing regression effort and enabling consistent 2-week release cycles
- Designed and scaled TypeScript/Cypress test automation used by 10 teams; expanded adoption from 11 to 35 repositories by standardizing framework practices and test architecture
- Integrated UI automation into Gitlab CI/CD pipelines, reducing release hardening time from hours to minutes and ensuring on-schedule sprint deployments
- Built and scaled reusable Cypress (with Testing Library) commands and guardrails for API mock/contract-dependent behavior and feature flags, reducing repetitive manual test processes by 75% while improving test consistency
- Served as the primary escalation point for flaky and ambiguous failures; separated product defects from automation, network, and environment issues, and coordinated fixes with owning teams
- Led QA platform team's Jira board migration from Kanban to Agile sprints, leveraging feature team experience to bridge both workflows and align QA cadence with feature team sprint cycles, reducing cross-team friction

Software Engineer, Dec 2018 - Dec 2021

Built web features during Ally's critical Ember-to-React migration, then expanded ownership into test modernization. The Cypress proof of concept, training, and shared patterns established in this role became the technical path into QA-platform leadership.

- Delivered and validated frontend web features across Ember and React using Jest, BrowserStack, Swagger for contract changes, and Voiceover before QA handoff

- Championed Cypress adoption by participating in proof-of-concept, then led training and established foundational patterns that became the organization's shared approach
- Migrated automated tests alongside React architecture changes, preserving regression protection during the platform transition
- Created API mocks and traced UI failures to contract changes using Swagger for validation

Reason Consulting Corporation (previously Tax Management Associates), Charlotte, NC
Software Engineer **Jan 2018 - Nov 2018**

- Trained UI/UX designers in React, improving design-to-development workflow and reducing iteration friction
- Built 2 production React applications, translating requirements into scalable, user-facing solutions

Junior Frontend Developer / Apprentice **Oct 2015 - Dec 2017**

- Contributed to frontend development using JavaScript and React, supporting delivery of user-facing applications in an Agile environment

Continuous Learning & Projects

Independent Study & Projects **Dec 2025 - Aug 2026**

QA/SDET Claude Code Plugin - github.com/TzolkinB/skills

Evidence-driven test auditing, Playwright/Cypress flake/drift triage

- Individual and orchestration layer of 10+ QA/SDET Claude Code skills enforcing the principal that "a green test is not proof"
- Skills include mutation-based test auditing, E2E test-impact analysis, and flake/drift triage for the Playwright/Cypress domain
- Validated blind against a third-party app with an evidence-provenance standard, contract-guard, and calibrated release gate in progress

Playwright Test Collection - github.com/TzolkinB/playwright-test-collection

Framework migration + CI integration (Playwright + TS + Github Actions)

- Migrated an existing Cypress suite to Playwright with Typescript, and Github Actions
- Used Github Copilot to accelerate test code generation and debug test failures
- Covers UI integration tests and REST API tests, with shared fixtures and helper abstractions to eliminate duplication across spec files

LoopQA Playwright Suite - github.com/TzolkinB/loop-playwright

Scalable POM + data-driven tests + reusable auth/fixtures

- LoopQA: Built a data-driven Playwright test suite using the Page Object Model (POM), JSON data, Typescript enums, a reusable authentication setup, responsive web/mobile tests, and designed for scalability
- Separated scenario data from test logic so new cases can be added through data files with requiring changes to the test code

Skills

Languages & Frameworks: JavaScript, Typescript, React
Testing: Playwright, Cypress, Jest, Testing Library, E2E, Integration, Regression, API Testing, API Mocking, Accessibility (Voice Over), Responsive, SQL
CI/CD & Tools: Git, Gitlab CI/CD, Github Actions, Bitbucket, BrowserStack, LogRocket, Jira, Confluence, qTest
AI-Assisted QA: Claude Code, Github Copilot

Education

Master of Arts (MA), International Human Rights, University of Denver, Denver, CO
Bachelor of Arts (BA), Anthropology, North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC